TEAM CHARTER

Project Title:	Mary's Consulting – New Company Website	Date Prepared:	May 18, 2026

Team Values and Principles

1.	**Respect** – We treat each other and our stakeholders with respect, even under deadline pressure.
2.	**Transparency** – We surface issues and risks early rather than hide them; bad news travels faster than good news on this team.
3.	**Quality** – We hold ourselves to a high bar; accessibility and security are non-negotiable, not optional polish.
4.	**Ownership** – Each team member owns their domain fully; the PM owns escalation, not micromanagement.
5.	**Continuous improvement** – We retro at the end of each phase and adjust how we work.

Meeting Guidelines

1.	Weekly team standup, Monday 9:30–10:00 AM, in-person or video.
2.	Sponsor steering, last Friday of each month, 30 minutes.
3.	Every meeting has a written agenda 24 hours in advance and a written outcome within 24 hours after.
4.	Camera-on default for video calls; turning off is fine when context calls for it.
5.	Decisions made in meetings are recorded in the Decision Log; if you're not in the room, you'll see it there.

Communication Guidelines

1.	Slack for fast sync; email for decisions and external stakeholders; ticket system for work tracking.
2.	Response expectations: Slack ≤ 4 business hours; email ≤ 1 business day; tickets ≤ 2 business days.
3.	After hours: no expectation of response. Mark urgent issues with @here only when truly urgent.
4.	When stuck for > 2 hours, ask. Heroes-in-silence is an anti-pattern on this team.
5.	PM is the single point of contact for sponsor and external-stakeholder communication unless explicitly delegated.

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Decision-Making Process

Within team domain: Each team member has authority to make decisions within their domain (Bob – tech, Bill – design, Christine – content) without PM approval, as long as the decision fits inside the approved scope, schedule, and budget.
Cross-domain: Decisions affecting multiple domains are surfaced to the PM and decided by team consensus when possible. PM has tie-breaker authority.
Outside scope/baseline: Decisions that change scope, schedule, or cost go through the formal change-control process and require sponsor approval per the PM Plan.
Decisions logged: All cross-domain or sponsor-level decisions are recorded in the Decision Log.

Conflict Resolution Process

Step 1 – Direct conversation: The team members involved attempt to resolve the conflict directly within 1 business day.
Step 2 – PM facilitation: If unresolved, the PM facilitates a discussion within 2 business days.
Step 3 – Sponsor escalation: Conflicts that affect scope, cost, schedule, or quality and cannot be resolved by the PM are escalated to the Sponsor.
Tone: Disagree with ideas, not people. Focus on what's best for the project, not on personal preferences.

Other Agreements

- **Working hours:** Core hours 10 AM – 3 PM ET; outside core hours, team members work flexibly.
- **Vacation:** Notify the team and PM at least 2 weeks in advance for vacations > 1 day.
- **On-call:** Bob is on-call during the 2-week hypercare window after launch; rotation arranged afterward.
- **Knowledge sharing:** All design and code stored in the firm's shared repositories; no personal-drive-only artifacts.
- **Charter is living:** This charter can be amended by team consensus and re-signed; review at each phase gate.

Signatures

Name / Role	Signature	Date
Andrew (PM)		May 18, 2026
Bob (Web Developer)		May 18, 2026
Bill (UX Designer)		May 18, 2026
Christine (Content Strategist)		May 18, 2026